



Chloe Cho <ccho@science-corps.org>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Vasileios Nittas

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

Sun, Jan 31, 2021 at 7:42 AM

To: fellows@science-corps.org

Name

Vasileios Nittas

Gender

Male

Nationality

Greek and German

Emailvasileios.nittas@uzh.ch**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

19.01.2021

City, state, and country of residence

Zurich, Canton of Zurich, Switzerland

University education

PhD in Epidemiology, University of Zurich (Switzerland), 19.01.2021

Master of Science in Evidence-based Social and Health Policy, University of Oxford (United Kingdom), 30.01.2017

Bachelor of Science in European Public Health, Maastricht University (Netherlands), 30.07.2016

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

To me, science, in its essence, is about inspiring curiosity; it is about encouraging exploration and ultimately about pushing boundaries and breaking silos. Unfortunately, some of these

boundaries, the boundaries of inequality and inequity remain unbroken. Unequal access to high-quality education, including STEM education, is a problem with far-reaching, global consequences. For me, science, specifically digital epidemiology, has been a life-changing journey. It has been and is a privilege, allowing me to grow, inspire and achieve things I could not have dreamt of 15 years ago. If I position myself in a teenager's shoes that might have similar aspirations but never get the chances I had to pursue that journey, triggers a feeling of unease and discomfort. Our world is not a fair one, but I do believe that we, the future generation of scientists, professionals, and leaders have the power to change that. This is why I admire the mission of Science Corps. Education and science have given me a lot; and I am ready to give back. It is my obligation and privilege to give back; to inspire, encourage and open paths. This is why I want to join your cause.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

Below a list of experiences and brief explanations of what I've learned and consider essential for a Science Corps fellowship:

[1] Visiting research fellow positions in India

- taught me resilience, the art of networking, socio-cultural adaptation, and conducting research in low-resource, hierarchical settings

[2] Being a member of the European Health Parliament & a group leader for Polygeia Global Health Think

- taught me knowledge translation, science outreach, and communication to different target groups, as well as the importance of cross-sectoral collaboration and dialogue to solving societal challenges

[3] Extensive teaching activities in public health, epidemiology, and statistics

- taught me effective (and fun) science education through engaging and interactive ways, co-produced teaching, and impactful knowledge communication

[4] Co-organization of several conferences and contribution to the International Consortium of Teaching Epidemiology

- Taught me efficient and collaborative organization (of time and resources) and equipped me with a deeper understanding of the epidemiological and biostatistical teaching curriculum

[5] My wanderlust and travels – being a backpacker at heart!

– taught me A LOT! I learned to adapt fast; to cherish, value, and respect culture, beliefs, and traditions; to respect nature and nurture human relationships, empathy, and exchange!

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

Upon completion of my postdoctoral fellowship at Brown University, starting in 2022 and ending in 2023 I will return to Switzerland and apply for a four-year Swiss National Science Foundation grant, kick-starting my scientific independence. That grant will be in collaboration with the University of Kampala, allowing my research activities to be split between Zurich and Uganda. I will retain my research focus on digital epidemiology, prevention, and health promotion, as well as on methodologies that are built around the needs, and preferences of disadvantaged and marginalized communities. Focusing on Uganda's rural and sub-urban regions, I aim to explore emerging questions on fairness and equity, providing practical and implementable digital health solutions to solve key healthcare utilization barriers, as well as epidemiological and emergency preparedness gaps. In the long-term, I see myself in an independent and permanent academic position (tenure track) in Switzerland. I see myself as an established scientist, using Switzerland's wonderful academic resources to establish impactful collaborations in low-resource settings. I aim to create a research culture around digital epidemiology (and digital public health) that will be person-centered and equity-focused, applicable, and sensitive to the needs of all those that are being systematically disadvantaged.

CV/Resumé

[CV_VasileiosNittas.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

Institutional newsletter

Any extra comment or message.

Thank you for considering my application & greets from snowy Zurich!

Sent from Science Corps